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HEALTHWATCH: BENEFITS OF NANO TECH *PG 11*



A MAJOR FORCE Union home minister Amit Shah at the BSF's diamond jubilee celebrations in Bhuj, Gujarat, Nov. 2025

▶ CENTRAL ARMED POLICE FORCES

RETAINING IPS SUPREMACY

A proposed bill by the Union home ministry seeks to formalise IPS dominance in top police positions but the measures to ease career stagnation among CAPF officers draw flak from the Opposition

By RAHUL NORONHA

SERVICE RULES GOVERNING PROMOTIONS AND SENIOR POSTINGS have long fuelled tensions between officers of the Indian Police Service (IPS) and the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs). Now, the Union ministry of home affairs—the cadre-controlling authority for both groups—is seeking to formalise that arrangement through legislation. This is after the Supreme Court in May 2025 reaffirmed that CAPF officers constitute Organised Group 'A' Services (OGAS) and are entitled to parity with other such services. It also directed the government to reduce the presence of IPS officers at the Inspector General (IG) level over the next two years.

The Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Bill, 2026, introduced in Parliament, is the home ministry's response to create a statutory framework for personnel management across CAPFs. In effect, it codifies the extensive presence of IPS officers in senior command positions. For CAPF cadre officers, that raises a long-standing concern—stagnant career progression. Union minister of state for home Nityanand Rai tabled the bill in the Rajya Sabha amidst protests from Opposition MPs, who accused the government of attempting to overturn the SC ruling.